Face-Baggage

a play by

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(Play opens in a Facebook office. Nikki is sitting at her desk. Danny walks in.)

Nikki
Hi welcome to Facebook. I'm Nikki. Please have a seat.

Danny
(A little timid) Hi. I've never actually been here before.

Nikki
That's ok. Have a seat. So what can I do for you today?

Danny
I would like to sign up for Facebook

Nikki
Ok, great. We can do that for you.

Danny
Yeah, I've been trying to avoid it this whole time. I think people tend to get a little too obsessed with it and it almost takes over their lives.

Nikki
Yeah, that's been known to happen.

Danny
Yeah, well I would really just like something basic. I'm more interested in keeping touch with friends and family. I have a sister who lives across the country so I'd really like to stay in touch with her. Maybe even meet knew people, you know, nothing too crazy.

Nikki
That's fine. Ok, then let me just activate an account for you. Name please?

Danny
Danny Costa. Do you need to see my ID?

Nikki
No, we'll just take your word for it.

Danny
So I can just make up a name and a fake account to go along with it?

Nikki
You could if you want to. But you said you just "wanted something basic". So let's get started on your profile. We'll start off with Basic Information. Ok. Are you single, in a relationship, married?

Danny
Single.

Nikki
Ok. Really? A good looking guy like you...

Danny
Yeah....well...I don't know....it's complicated.

Nikki

OH!?!?!

Danny
What?

Nikki
Would you like me to put its complicated?

Danny
I thought it was just being single or being in a relationship

Nikki
Well yes, but you can also put down "it’s complicated"

Danny
What’s complicated?

Nikki
It.

Danny
What's it?

Nikki
Let’s just skip it for now. Political Views?

Danny
Wow, really? Uh, I’m pretty moderate I guess.

Nikki
Ok. Religious Views?

Danny
Uh. I don't know. I guess I believe in God

Nikki
Ok. That's fine. Which God?

Danny
The one from the Bible I guess

Nikki
OK, good. So I’ll put down Christian

Danny
Well, no. I mean I don't go to church or anything

Nikki
So. Catholic?

Danny
Yeah I guess. Or No, I wouldn't per say call myself....Let’s just put other.

Nikki
Sure. Ok. Now lets move on to Personal Information

Danny
That wasn't personal enough?

Nikki
Haha. No sir. We still need to cover your activities, interests, favorite music, movies, books, and quotes.

Danny
Well wouldn't my favorite music, movies and books just go under interests?

Nikki
I don’t make up the rules sir. I just work here.

Danny
Fine. I guess for activities you can put hanging out with friends. Interests you can put sports and partying. Music you can put rock and hip hop. Movies...I guess...godfather and scarface. And I don’t really have any favorite books or quotes.

Nikki
Ok....

Danny
Is something wrong?

Nikki
No, no. That's fine. This is all fine...I just...wonder why you're interested in joining facebook when you obviously already lead such an exciting life.

Danny
I'm sorry what?

Nikki
Nothing. Enough with all the information. Moving on. How do you feel?

Danny
What?

Nikki
How do you feel? Right now?

Danny
Right now....I don’t know. I guess...slightly confused by all of this.

Nikki
Aright. Danny….is...slightly...confused...by...all...of...this

Danny
What did you just do?

Nikki
Oh, I just updated your status

Danny
Ok what's that for?

Nikki

Now all your friends know that you're feeling slightly confused by all of this

Danny
Why? I don't think they would really care

Nikki
It doesn't matter if they care. I'll let you in on a little secret. Most people actually don't care how you feel. They may be bored at work and looking through their friends statuses but they really don't care how how happy you are that you're engaged or how sad you are that someone you know is dead.

Danny
So then what's the point of updating your status?

Nikki
Let's move on to the final piece. Your profile picture. Did you bring a photo to use as your main profile pic?

Danny
Yes I did. (Hands her a photo)

Nikki
(Sarcastic) Oh...you squatting down next to your car. That's great.

Danny
Is it?

Nikki
Yeah, sure. I bet nobody has a picture like this.

Danny
I was thinking of maybe using a picture of my new tattoos, but you can't really see my face in them.

Nikki
Oh. Wonderful. This will do for now.

Danny
So can I find my friends and family now?

Nikki
Well since we started you've already had 5 friend requests.

Danny
Oh, nice. Is my sister one of them? (Looks at the requests) Oh my god. These are all people I went to high school with. I wasn't even in the same grade at *this* guy.

Nikki
What about this other guy? It says you two are related.

Danny
Uh…if you count step-father's cousin as "family". Yeah, I'd like to ignore these to be honest. You said there were 5 friend requests. Who's the fifth?
(Nikki smiles. Points to herself)
Oh.....ok. Yeah sure ill accept you.

Nikki
Cool beans

Danny
So now how would I find my current friends?
(Looks at him)
What...what?

Nikki
Come here

Danny
What is it?

Nikki
Come closer. (Pokes him in the nose)

Danny
Um. Ok.

Nikki
I just poked you, silly

Danny
Yeah I noticed. (Beat) So how would I go about finding my friends? (Silence)

Nikki
Are you gonna poke me back? (Confusion) Come on you can't just leave me hanging.
(Awkwardly pokes her in the arm. A is happy)
So, you would like to find your current friends.

Danny
Yes please. That's really all I wanted to do.

Nikki
Ok. Well there are several ways we can do this. We can check "people you may know" or we can.....oh no. Oh no no no.

Danny
What...

Nikki
Oh man I'm sorry. Your vampire was just attacked.

Danny
What

Nikki
Listen to me. Someone just attacked your zombie; if you don't retaliate now then you'll be stuck as an ensign zombie forever.

Danny
What do I do?

Nikki
Click here. Click here!!!. Ok now click here. Now click attack. There. You did it.

Danny

That's it?

Nikki
How did that feel?

Danny
I guess it felt pretty ok

Nikki
Good, cause you're gonna have to do it again, a vampire just bit you.

Danny
What do I do?

Nikki
Bite back bite back bit back

Danny
Ok ok. Jeez. Is that it? Can I find my sister now?

Nikki
You can. But first, I strongly suggest you join this cause.

Danny
What cause?

Nikki
Save Darfur.

Danny
What?

Nikki
You need to join the cause to save Darfur.

Danny
I don't even know who Darfur is.

Nikki
Listen…if you don't join the cause to save Darfur then they're all going to die. Do you want innocent people to die?

Danny
No. All I really want is to just stay in touch with my sister…

Nikki
So you want the people of Darfur to die. That's fine, that's fine.

Danny
All right! I'll join your cause. But then I'm just gonna give my sister a call.

Nikki
NO!!! I mean, why would you want to call her?

Danny
Because. She just had a baby last week and I want to see how she's doing.

Nikki
Oh! I see now. Well then, we can keep you in contact with your sister.

Danny
Thank you.

Nikki
In fact, you can also see photos and videos of her new baby when she posts them to her account.

Danny
That would be great.

Nikki
And you can also send her bumper stickers.

Danny
What's that?

Nikki
Just look. I already sent you a bumper sticker. Accept it. See, it's a picture of a puppy and a kitty cuddling and it says "BFF". Isn't that great?

Danny
No, not really. Listen, my sister's name is (name). If you can just do a quick search for her.

Nikki
(Slightly offended) Ok. All right, there, I found her.

Danny
Thank you. Can you add her for me please?

Nikki
I can. But wouldn't you rather vote for which one of us is hotter?

Danny
What? No! That's gross.

Nikki
So vote that I'm hotter than your sister.

Danny
No, I won't. Listen, my sister just had a baby. This is a very important event in our lives.

Nikki
Important event? I'll tell *you* about "important events"! My friend is looking to sublet an apartment in Park Slope this summer. Only 800 dollars a month before utilities.

Danny
For Christ's sake. (Gets up and pulls out his cell phone) That's it I'm just gonna phone my sister myself.

Nikki
I wouldn't do that if I were you.

Danny
You're gonna try and stop me from calling my own sister?

Nikki
Not me. But the Mafia will.

Danny
What mafia?

Nikki
MY Mafia. Don't make me start a war with you.

Danny
This is getting out of control. I thought facebook was just about networking with people.

Nikki
It is. It always has been. (Starts to hit on him) So much so that you don't even need that precious little phone anymore.

Danny
Excuse me?

Nikki
Why would you want to have a long boring conversation with someone on the phone, when you can just as easily show someone how much you appreciate them by sending them a martini on facebook?

Danny
Because that doesn't…

Nikki
Don't you want to have a martini with me?

Danny
I…

Nikki
Yeah. Why don't you just give me your phone maybe we can…super poke. (They're about to kiss, until he stops)

Danny
No. I can't do this. Look, I'm sure all these things you can do on facebook are fun, but I still think that the best way to stay in touch with my family is to just call.

Nikki
(Starts to lose it) Don't you ever use the C-word around me again!

Danny
Call?

Nikki
Ahhh!

Danny
Ok, this is crazy, you're crazy, and now I think facebook is crazy. I would appreciate it if you just delete my account.

Nikki
Ha! Oh, we can "deactivate" your account if you want. But nothing ever gets deleted. It's online forever!

Danny
Um, ok. I guess I just won't log on then.

Nikki
(Foiled) Fine! You know what? Facebook doesn't need you! I don't need you. You think you're my only appointment today? There are thousands of people signing up for facebook each and every day. Normal people, famous people, politicians, corporations. You can't stop us! No one can stop us!

Danny
I'm not actually trying to stop you. I just got a text from my sister. It's a picture of my nephew. Wanna see?

Nikki
Get out!!!! (B awkardly leaves. She goes back to her desk and pages secretary) You can send in Barack Obama now.

End